



Write the Steps

Write the algorithm in order

Name: _____

Date: _____

★ I can write the steps of a task in the right order.

Write an algorithm

Writing an algorithm means writing the steps in order. Use the step bank to write the steps for brushing your teeth in the right order. Then write your own algorithm.

Brush your teeth — step bank (mixed up)

A. brush your teeth

B. wet the brush

C. rinse your mouth

D. put on toothpaste

1 Write the steps in order

Write the four steps in the right order on the lines (you can use the letters). Step 1 first, down to step 4.

2 Why this order?

Which step must be FIRST? Could you brush before you put on toothpaste? Tell why the order matters.

3 You try — write your own

Write your own algorithm: how do you get ready for bed? Write 3 or 4 steps in order, one per line.

Big idea

When you write the steps of a task in the right order, you have written an algorithm. A good algorithm has each step where it needs to be.



Write the Steps

Quick facilitation notes & answer key

What this worksheet teaches

Students write an algorithm: they order the steps for brushing teeth, explain why that order is needed, then write their own bedtime routine. Writing the steps of a task in order is making a plan. No coding experience needed.

Before you start (no computer needed)

No computer — paper and a pencil. You read each prompt aloud. Optional: cut the steps into cards so students can physically slide them into order before writing.

How to lead it (about 20 minutes)

1. Show them (you do). You cannot brush before the toothpaste is on — so that step comes first.
2. Do one together. Order the brushing steps (Ex 1) and say why (Ex 2).
3. Let them try. Students write their own bedtime routine in order (Ex 3).

Answer key (these are the verified correct answers)

Exercise 1 — Brush your teeth: wet the brush (B), put on toothpaste (D), brush your teeth (A), rinse your mouth (C).

Exercise 2 — "Wet the brush" must be first, and toothpaste must go on before brushing; swapping them breaks the routine.

Exercise 3 — open. A sample: put on pyjamas, brush teeth, read a book, turn off the light. Accept any 3–4 steps in a sensible order.

If students get stuck — and ways to adjust

Watch for: a sensible-sounding list that does not actually work in order. Ask them to act it out.

Make it easier: give a step bank and have them only order it.

Make it harder: ask them to add a fifth step in the right place.

Ontario curriculum link (official wording)

C3.1 — solve problems and create computational representations of mathematical situations by writing and executing code, including code that involves sequential events.

In plain terms: students put step-by-step instructions in the right order to get a result.

C3.2 — read and alter existing code, including code that involves sequential events, and describe how changes to the code affect the outcomes.

In plain terms: students read a set of steps, change or reorder one, and explain what the change did.

You'll know it worked when

The child writes a working ordered routine and can justify one of the orderings.